

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 306

By Boyd

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend the founding of the Major David Wilson Chapter of The Sons of the American Revolution.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing those outstanding civic organizations and their members who work with purpose, commitment, and enthusiasm to promote patriotism and preserve America's panoramic history and heritage; and

WHEREAS, one such worthy organization is the Major David Wilson Chapter of The Sons of the American Revolution, which was granted a charter on January 25, 2025, by the Tennessee Society Sons of the American Revolution Board of Governors at their regional meeting in Jackson; and

WHEREAS, the Sons of the American Revolution (SAR) is a patriotic, historical, and educational organization composed of male descendants of those who supported the American Revolution; members can trace their lineage back to individuals who either fought in the Revolutionary War, served in the Continental Congress, or contributed in other ways to the cause of American Independence; and

WHEREAS, the SAR was established in 1889 and has grown to include chapters across the United States and internationally, playing a key role in fostering a deeper understanding of American history and honoring the legacy of those who fought for independence; the SAR is also involved in the preservation of history, education, patriotic activities, and community service; and

WHEREAS, the Major David Wilson Chapter of the SAR is named in honor of a native of North Carolina who enlisted in the Rowan County Regiment of the North Carolina Militia under

Colonel Francis Locke; his journey in the Revolutionary War was distinguished by his participation in several critical battles and engagements; and

WHEREAS, later in life, Major Wilson moved to what is now Sumner County, where he was very involved in local government and served as the first Speaker of the House for the territory that would later become the State of Tennessee; he is also the namesake of Wilson County; and

WHEREAS, the first officers of the Major David Wilson Chapter of the SAR were sworn in on February 15, 2025, in a ceremony in Lebanon; the founding members of this newly established chapter are George Richard Bouton, Eugene Wade Bland, Isaac Lewis Bland, John Robert Emmert, James Howard Jordan, James Howard Murff, Edward Wayne Patton, Jerry Allen Vance, and Dannell Bennett Waters; and

WHEREAS, the charter members of the Major David Wilson Chapter of the SAR are Haywood St. Clair Barry, William Rex Bouton, Damon Clark Boyd, Paul Wayne Devine, Robert Coleman Fields, James Bradley Jordan, Jon Todd Hannah, Daniel Edward Hardison, David Floyd Howell, Jerry Gordon Hughes, James Chase Lannom, James David Peyton, David Melvin Roberts, Dwight Groom Saddler, Raymond Shane Stroud, Paul Calvert Stumb, Bruce Carleton Taylor, Eddie Linn Tomlinson, James Christopher Vance, Kevin Oakley Vance, Michael Ryan Vance, Timothy Owen White, and William O'Neill Whisenant; and

WHEREAS, the newly established Major David Wilson Chapter of the SAR is dedicated to preserving American history and fostering patriotism, and it is wholly fitting that this worthy organization should be honored at this time; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and commend the founding of the Major David Wilson Chapter of the Sons of the American Revolution, expressing our gratitude to its members for

their commitment to honoring the legacy of those who fought for American independence and extending our best wishes for every continued success in the future.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.